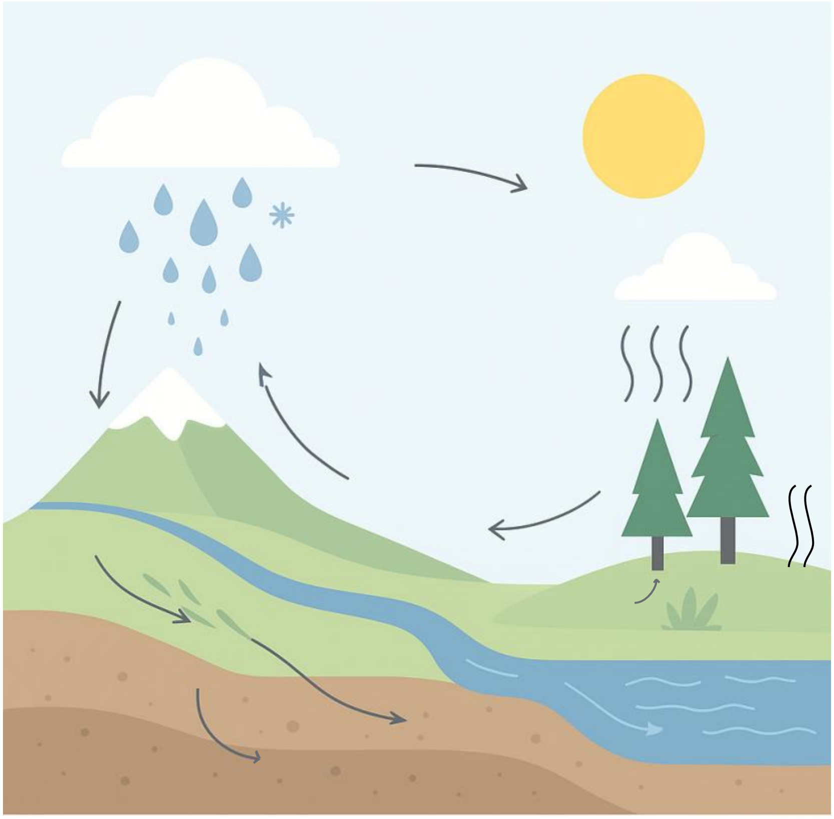
2.1 Hydrological processes

The water cycle is made up of a range of hydrological processes. These are the movements and changes of water as it shifts between the atmosphere, the land and the oceans. Water may change from one state to another (for example, liquid to gas or solid to liquid), and these ongoing processes help make water a renewable resource.

Identify and label the following processes on the diagram below, and then answer the questions. Definitions of the processes are available after on the next page to support you.

Precipitation	**Condensation**	**Evaporation**	**Evapotranspiration**	**Infiltration**
Plant uptake	**Surface runoff**	**Groundwater flow**	**Outflow of a river**	



1. Describe ONE process from the diagram.

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2. Explain why ONE process is important for the availability of freshwater in a catchment.

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3. Explain how humans can impact ONE process on the diagram.

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Definitions to support labelling activity.

Process	Definition	Process	Definition
Precipitation	Water falling from clouds to the ground as rain, snow, hail or sleet.	**Infiltration**	When water on the surface soaks into the soil.
Condensation	When water vapour in the air cools and turns back into liquid, forming clouds.	**Plant uptake**	When plant roots absorb water from the soil for growth.
Evaporation	When heat from the sun causes liquid water to change into water vapour and rise into the atmosphere.	**Surface runoff**	Water that flows across the land into creeks, rivers or lakes.
Transpiration	When plants release water vapour through tiny openings in their leaves.	**Groundwater flow**	Water that moves slowly through rocks and underground layers, eventually feeding rivers or springs.
Evapotranspiration	The combined water loss from evaporation (surfaces) and transpiration (plants).	**Outflow of a river**	The point where a river leaves the catchment, usually entering a lake, larger river or the ocean.